



Samsung LED TV

white and back again) for producing the image on the screen. The slower the pixel refresh rate of the panel, the higher the response time. This results in the judder and ghost image formation on fast-paced action scenes and sports watched on the TV.

Plasma screens refresh each individual cell much faster than LCD screens. So these can display fast motion free of blur and jitter. However, manufacturers are improving the way LCD TVs handle motions by introducing 120Hz sets—doubling the number of video frames and smoothing out the motion. Some have even introduced 240Hz TVs that quadruple the number of frames.

Screen reflection. LCD screens have matte finish as opposed to glossy plasma screens. So these don't suffer from screen glare as plasma screens do. The glass panel of plasma TV reflects light, which makes it difficult to watch in a brightly-lit room.

Many plasma TV manufacturers are using special techniques like anti-reflective filter to minimise reflections, however. The anti-glare coating being done on Hitachi Plasma TV screens lowers the reflectivity of the glass to a

great extent.

Power consumption. LCD TVs use a single fluorescent lamp for backlighting. On the other hand, the neon gas inside a plasma TV requires every sub-pixel to be lit individually, consuming more electricity.

In general, LCD TVs consume about half the power consumed by plasmas. This is one main reason why LCDs are widely used in computer monitors.

Price. Plasma TVs cost less than LCD TVs, especially at larger screen sizes. For instance, for the popular 102cm (40-inch) size, the difference in

price could be Rs 18,000 to Rs 20,000.

LED TVs: How good are they?

LED TVs are nothing but LCD TVs with LED backlighting. These allow the LCD to have better blacks, contrast and colours. While LED TVs still don't match plasma TVs in terms of picture quality, these fare far better than normal LCD TVs.

LCD TVs employ cold-cathode fluorescent lamps (CCFLs) for wide gamut colour reproduction. The demand for even more realistic colours has led to the growing popularity of



Sony Bravia ZX LCD TV